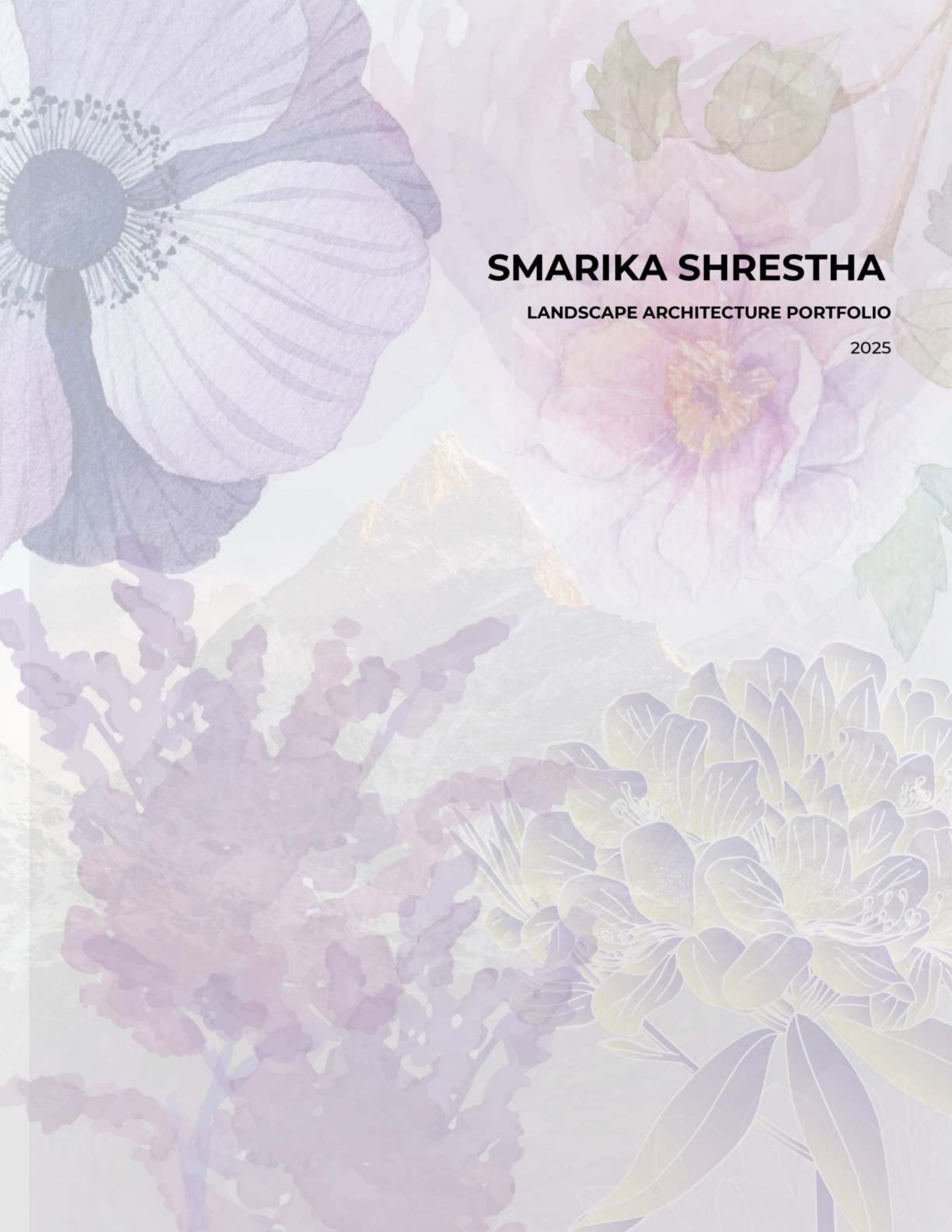


SMARIKA SHRESTHA

LANDSCAPE ARCHITECTURE PORTFOLIO

2025

ETHOS

The spaces we inhabit shape our experiences, influencing how we connect with each other and the world around us. Growing up in Nepal, I was surrounded by rich landscapes that fostered a deep appreciation for nature, but moving to Richmond, California, revealed the stark inequities in access to green spaces.

This contrast drives my passion for creating landscapes that are not only functional and beautiful but also sustainable and inclusive. I see landscape architecture as a tool for environmental justice, a way to bridge the gap between people and nature while addressing social and ecological challenges.

My work prioritizes accessibility, biodiversity, and resilience, ensuring that urban environments foster well-being rather than isolate people from nature. I aim to design spaces that encourage interaction, restoration, and a deeper connection to the environment, making sustainability an integral part of everyday life.

SELECTED WORKS

01

Beneath The Pavement, The Past

Honoring the Ohlone Shellmound through Design
Berkeley, California

BLA Student Project
Spring 2025
Landscape Architecture Studio

Contributions & Skills
Site Research, Concept Development, Design, Graphic Production, Drawing, Writing, Presentation, AutoCAD, Rhino, Photoshop, Illustrator

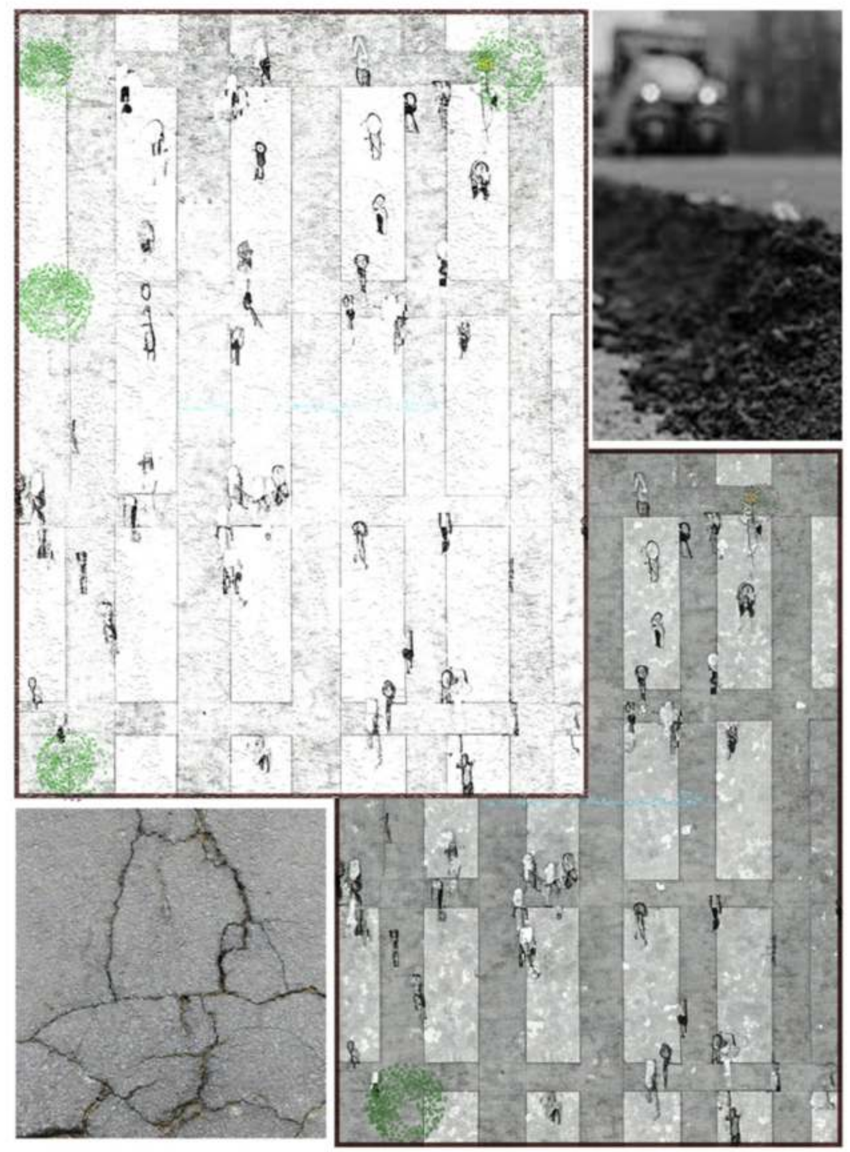
Site Research / Worldviews

The public park is located on 4th Street in Berkeley, an area of deep historical significance to the Ohlone people, the Bay Area's original inhabitants. The site is near the Berkeley Shellmound, once one of the region's largest, which served as a burial, ceremonial, and social center. Its destruction during 19th- and early 20th-century urban development left a void in the recognition of this cultural heritage.

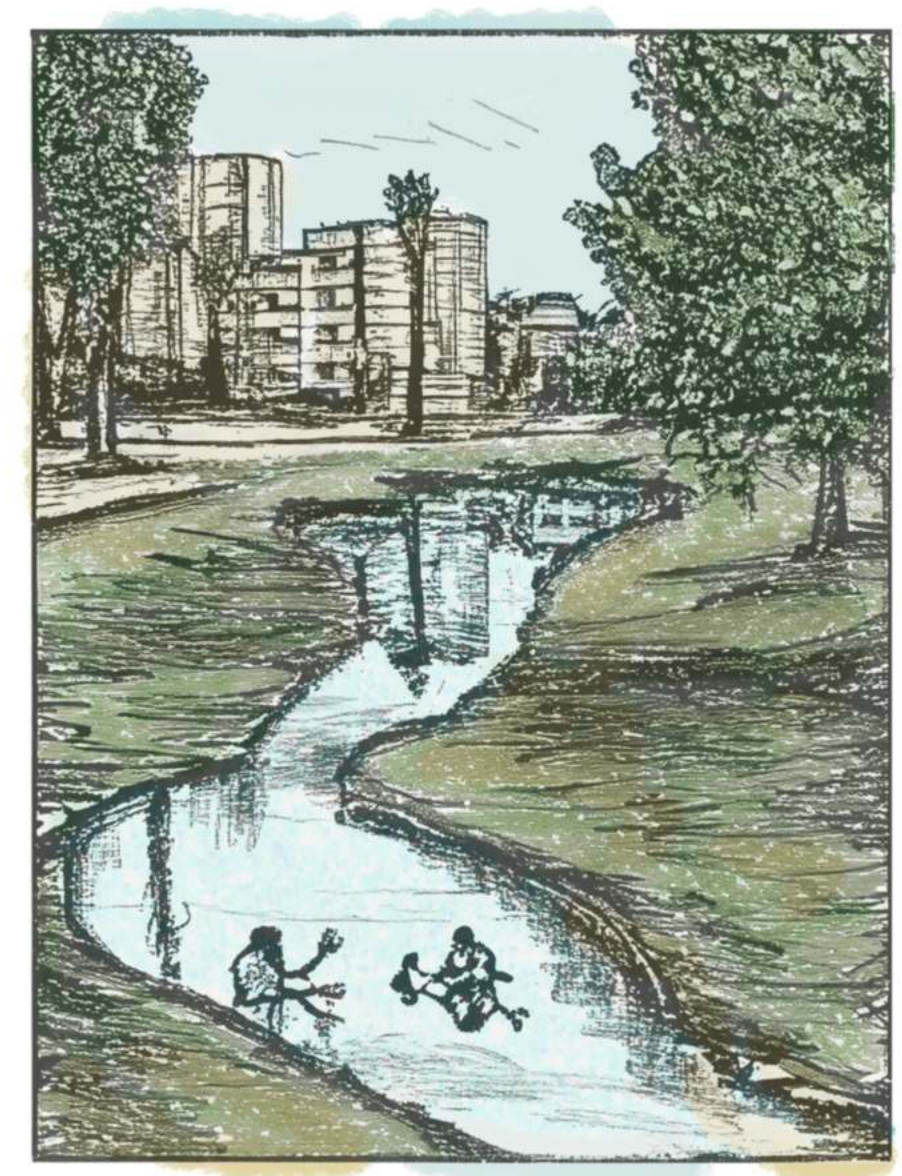
Today, the site—currently an abandoned parking lot—lies above the buried Strawberry Creek, a vital freshwater source that supported local ecosystems and the Ohlone community. Local Indigenous groups and activists have called for the site's preservation or transformation into a memorial or educational space.

This project seizes the opportunity to honor the Ohlone's history, reclaim Indigenous space, and restore ecological systems. Understanding the site's cultural and ecological layers informs the design concept, which is presented on the following page.

Traditional: Before colonization, the land was defined by soft, living textures —flowing creek water, wet soil, and dense trees shaped a sensory world rooted in care and stewardship.



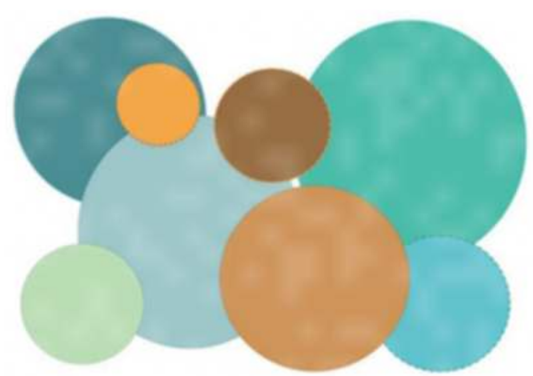
Modern: Urban development introduced new textures—hard pavement and heat-absorbing concrete—marking a shift toward disconnection and environmental strain.



Postmodern: A future of renewal is imagined through the daylighting of Strawberry Creek, where living and built elements converge. Here, textured pavement meets soil, trees, and water—restoring a coexisting relationship between humans and land.

Design Concept

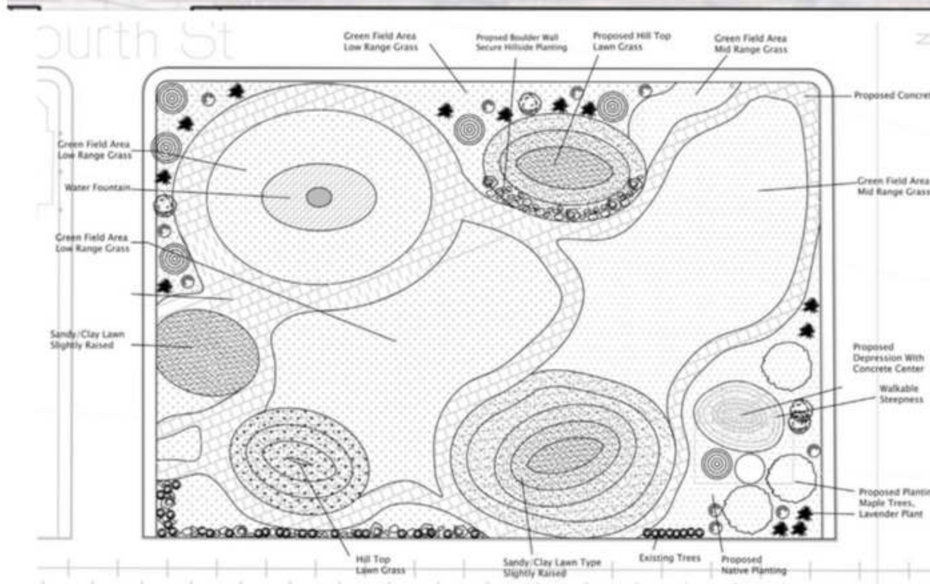
This park design honors the Ohlone worldview by foregrounding interconnectedness, cyclical processes, and healing through nature. Located near the historic Berkeley Shellmound and above the buried Strawberry Creek, the site holds deep cultural and ecological significance. The layout draws from Ohlone cosmology, using circular forms and looping paths to express cycles of life, growth, and renewal. A central water feature symbolizes healing, while a preserved concrete scar acknowledges fire and truth, representing both destruction and regeneration. These opposing force,s stillness and movement, memory and transformation balanced throughout the space to reflect Indigenous understandings of harmony. Interpretive elements and native plantings foster moments of reflection, inviting visitors to connect with the land and its layered histories. This design aims to reclaim space, elevate cultural memory, and create a sanctuary where healing and community gathering can unfold.

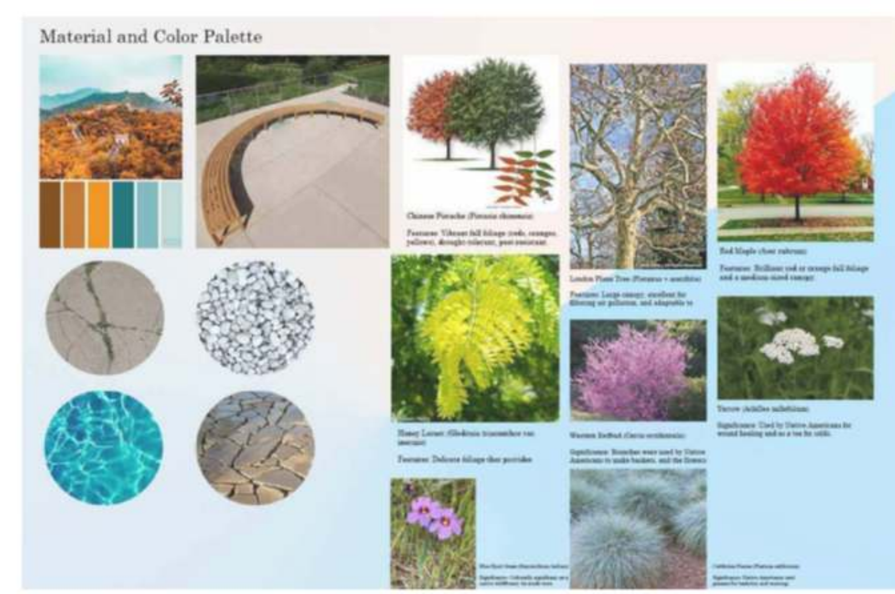


Parti 1: Cycles of Life Represented Through Circular Form

Parti 2: Honoring Truth Through Water and Fire

Parti 3: Complementary Duality into Design Spatial Organization:Form

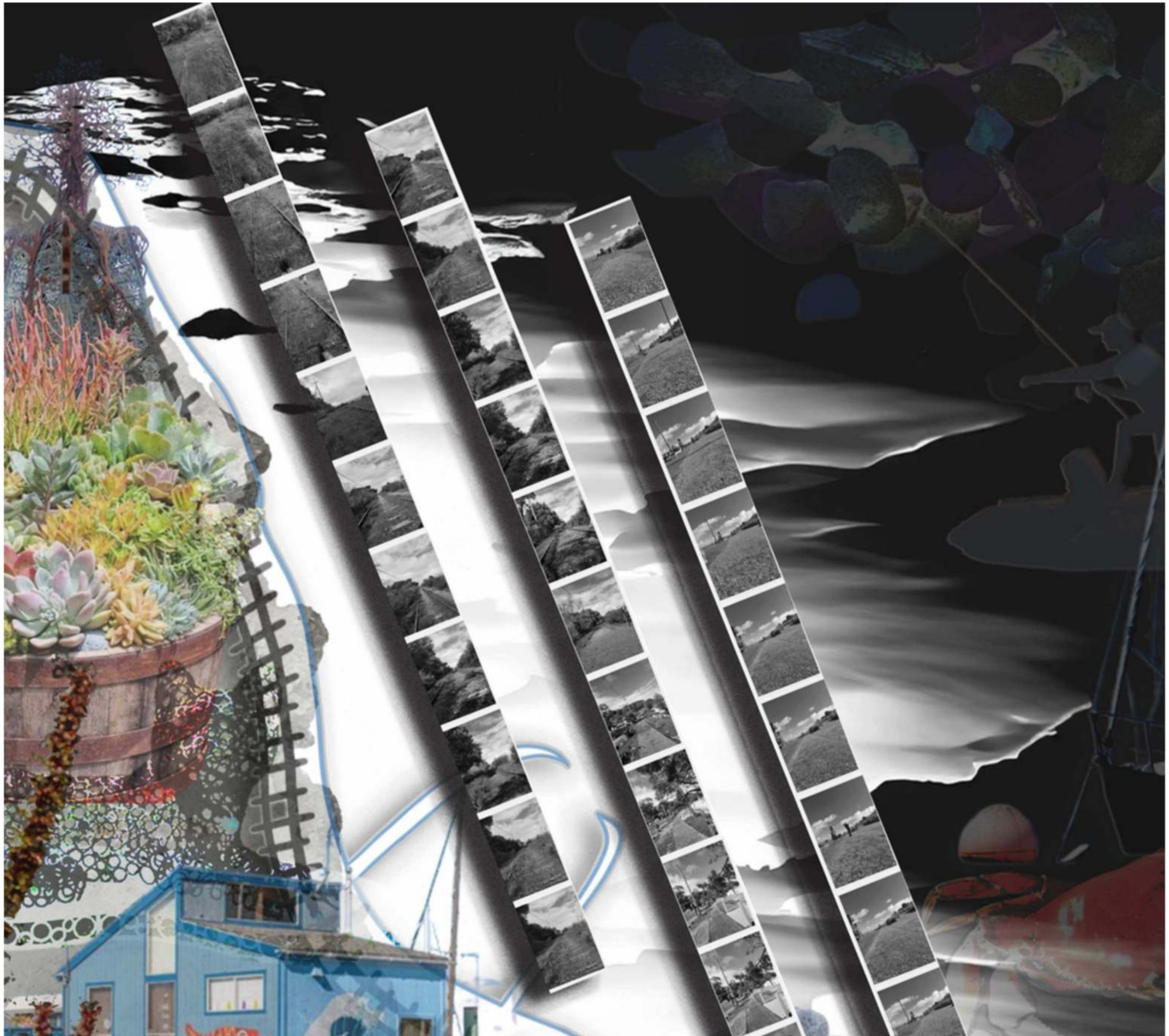




Section through Northeast Corner:
A walkable pathway gently descends into a shallow depression, revealing a preserved concrete layer beneath the surface. This exposed "scar" provides a moment of reflection, symbolizing the uncovering of buried histories and the tension between natural regeneration and urban intervention. The layered section encourages visitors to engage both physically and emotionally with the site's complex past.

Section through Elevated Water Fountain:
A horizontal section reveals the raised fountain at the heart of the park. Elevated above the ground, this water feature symbolically mirrors Strawberry Creek, which once flowed across the site but now runs buried beneath concrete. As a gesture of remembrance and renewal, the fountain reintroduces flowing water to the landscape, inviting visitors to pause, reflect, and reconnect with the site's natural and cultural history.

Section through Elevated Fountain and Landform:
This section illustrates the relationship between the raised water fountain and a gently mounded landform, inspired by the Ohlone shellmounds that once shaped this landscape. The hill serves as a quiet monument to ancestral burial and ceremonial sites, providing a space for reflection, gathering, and remembrance. Together, the fountain and landform create a dialogue between water, earth, and memory, inviting visitors to engage with the layered histories of the site.



Site Analysis Illustration

02

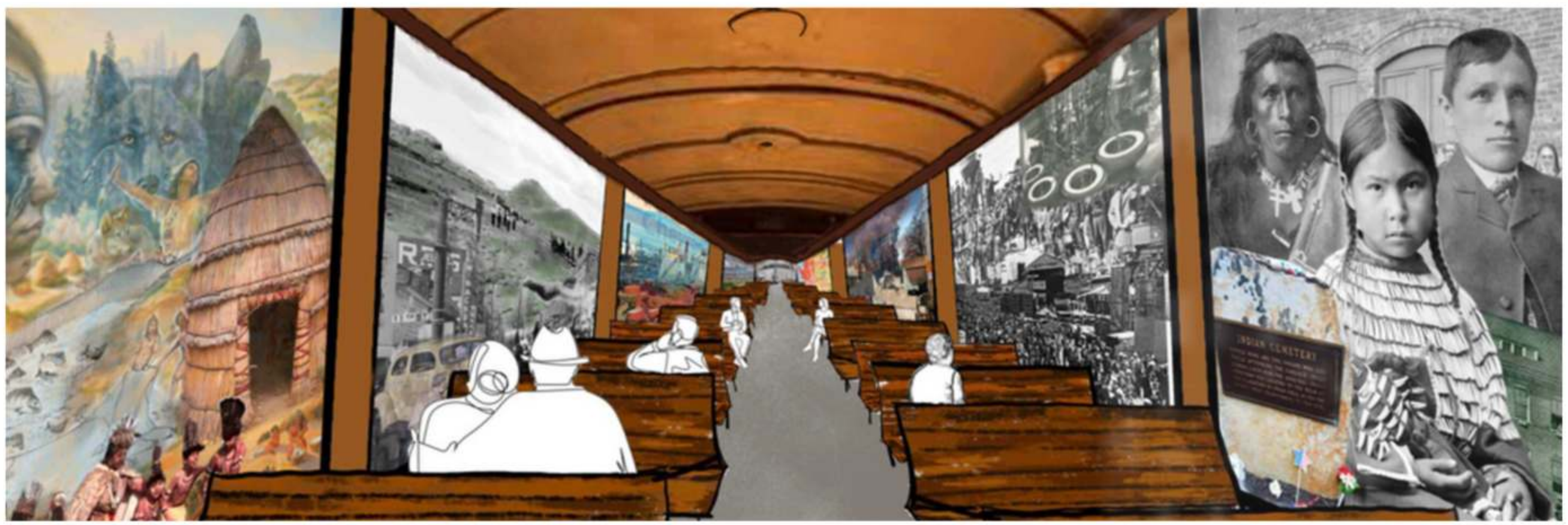
Revitalizing Point Richmond

A Vision for Community and Waterfront
Richmond, California

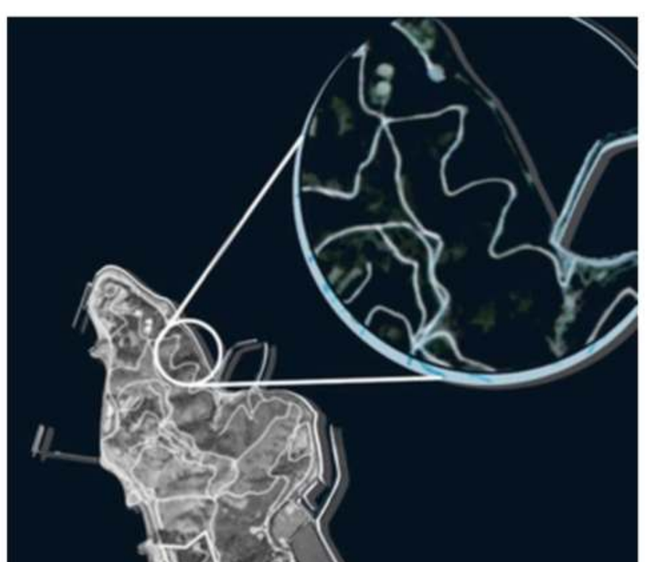
BLA Student Project
Spring 2024
Landscape Architecture Studio

Contributions & Skills
Site Research, Concept Development, Design, Graphic Production, Writing, Presentation

My Petrochemical Journey – Illustration
This piece traces my evolving relationship with Point Richmond. At first, from the backseat, the factories appeared as a whimsical play structure of colorful bubbles. Growing up, the view shifted to the front passenger seat, revealing smoke and fumes. Finally, from the driver's seat, the full reality emerged-pollution, wildfires, protests, and headlines-capturing the complex connection between place, memory, and environmental awareness.



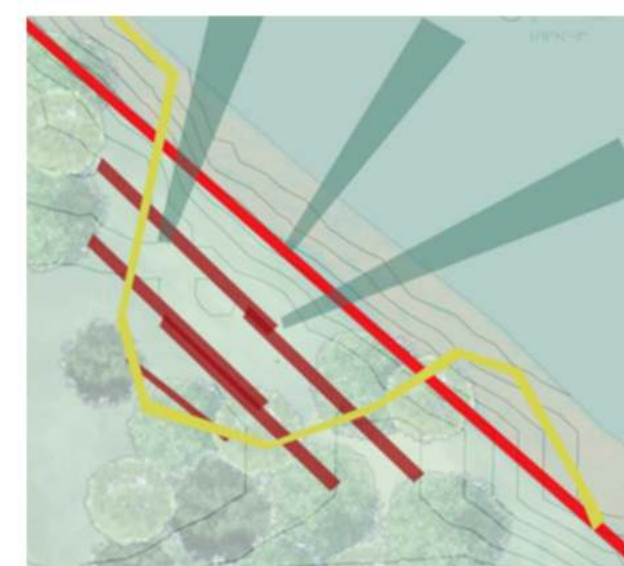
Richmond's Journal – Through the Train Window
This illustration uses a train as a vessel through time, with each window revealing a chapter of Richmond's layered history. Beginning with the land's first caretakers, the Native peoples the view shifts to scenes of industrialization and the rise of refineries, alongside the pollution and displacement they brought. The final window imagines a possible future: one shaped by resilience, restoration, and community hope. Each frame reflects how we move through history and how place holds memory.



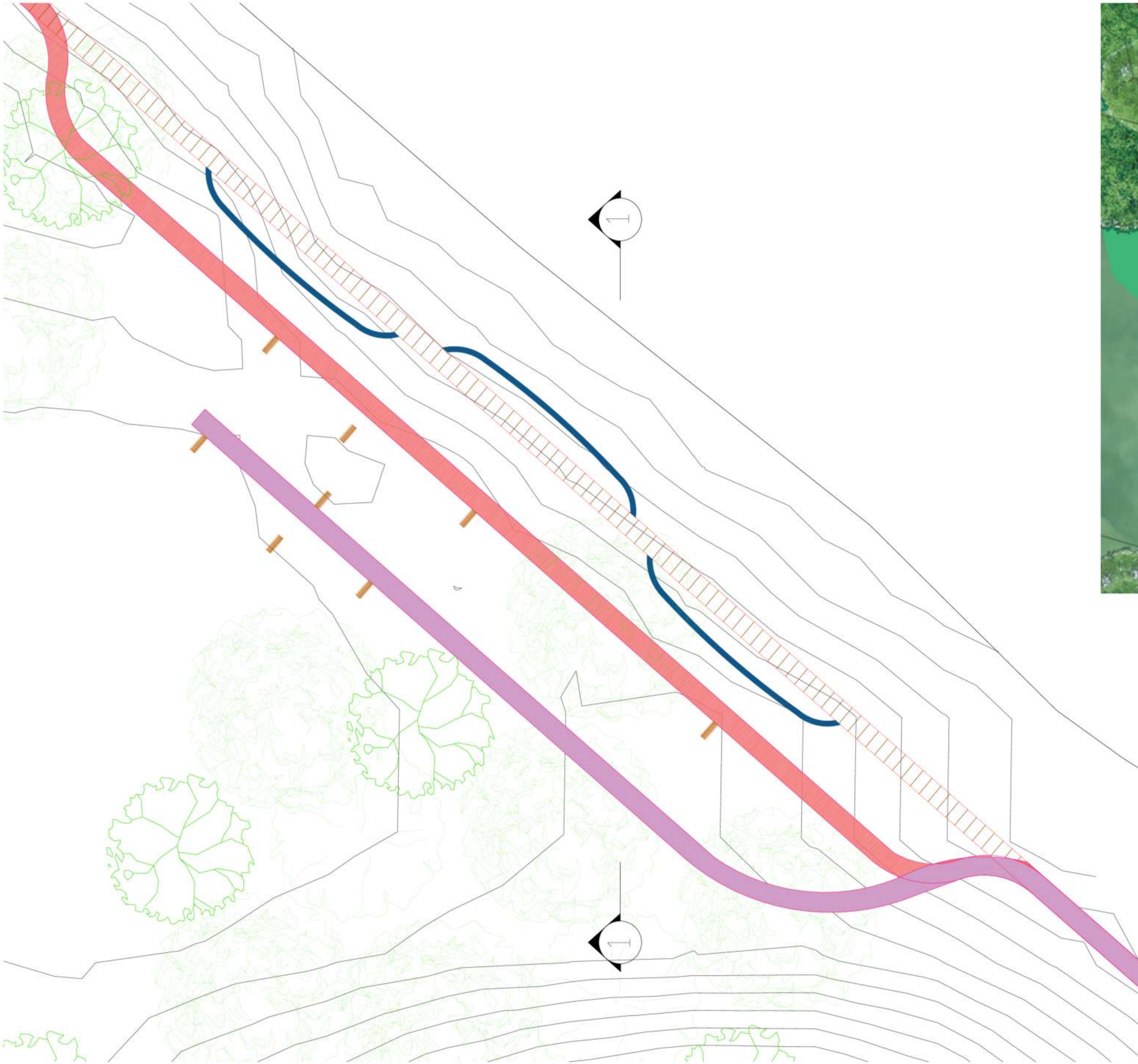
Site Map

Innital Concept

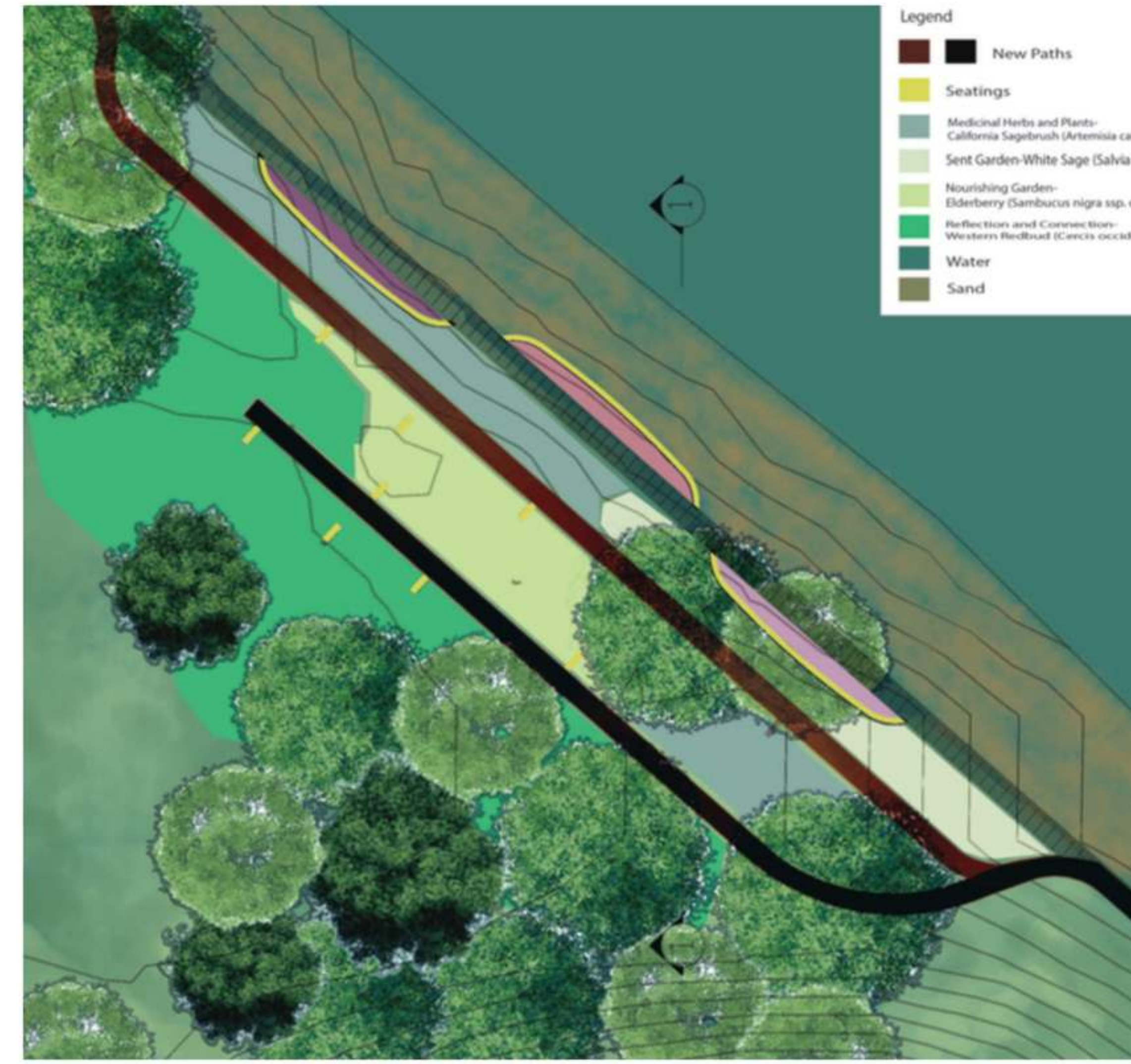
Parti Sketch 1



Parti Skectch 2



Plan Drawing



Point Richmond Revitalization Project

The Point Richmond area, known for its historic charm and stunning bay views, is a unique space with tremendous potential. Home to the Richmond Refinery and a vibrant sailboat community, it boasts a rich history—from its early days as a transportation hub to its current role as a local destination with restaurants, art events, and public spaces. Yet, public areas remain underutilized, leaving untapped opportunities to enhance community engagement, cultural activities, and waterfront access. This design envisions a revitalized Point Richmond that strengthens a sense of place, honors its history, and creates dynamic spaces for both residents and visitors to enjoy.

Perspective (Path 3)

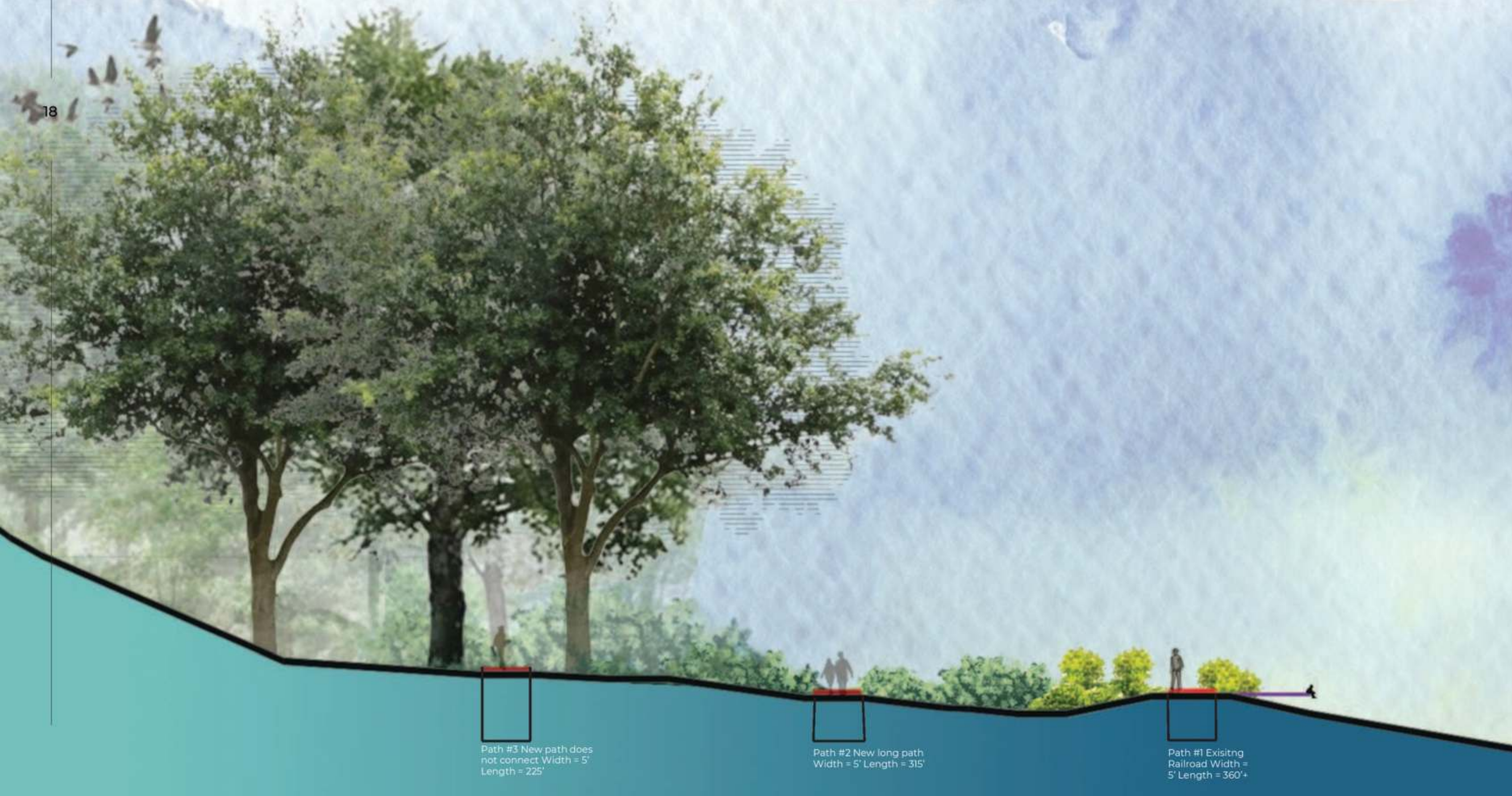
Perspective (Path 2)

Perspective (Path 1)

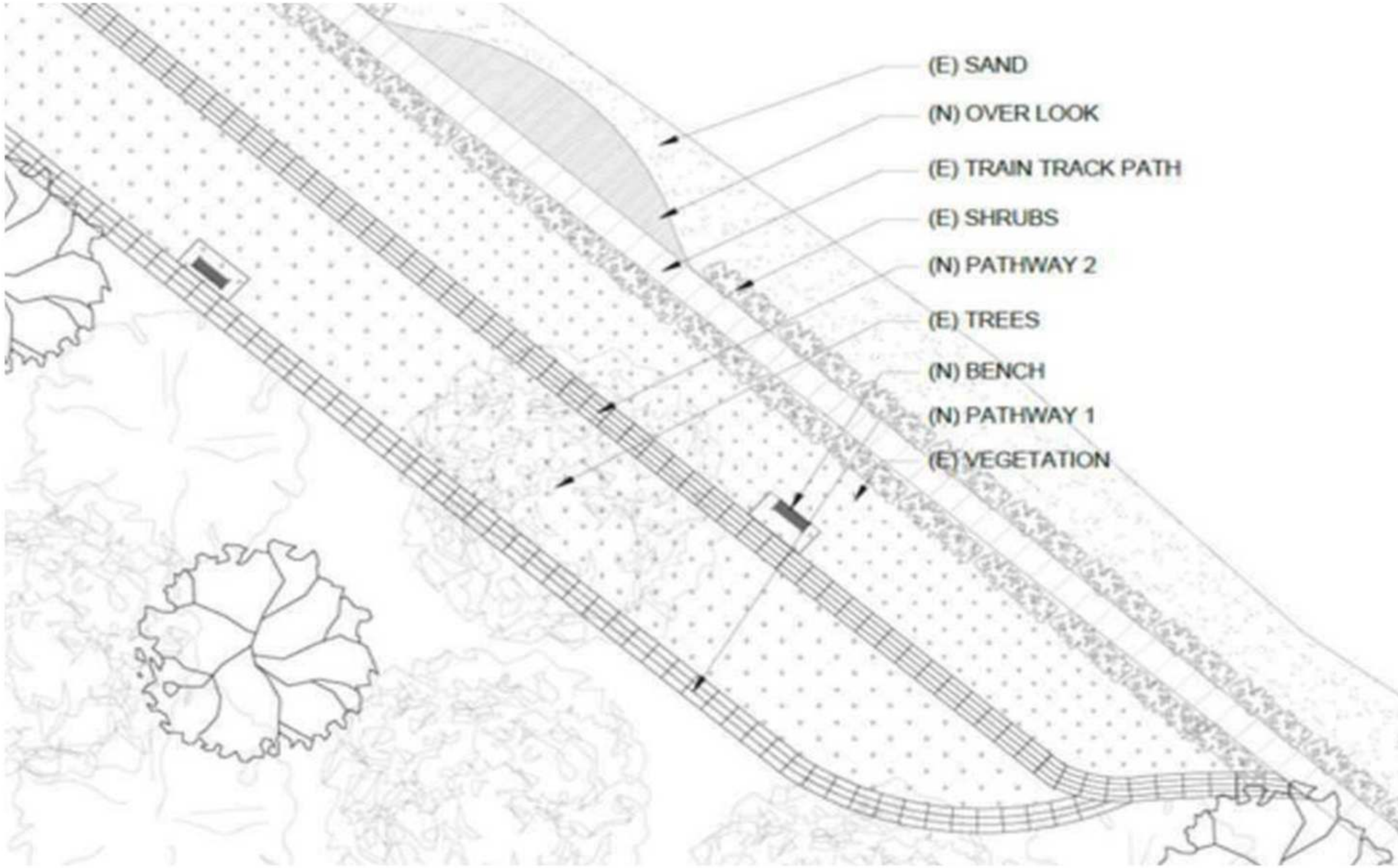
Design Concept

The design for Point Richmond focuses on harmoniously blending the area's rich historical elements with its stunning natural beauty. Drawing inspiration from the existing rail tracks, the project uses the linearity of the tracks to guide visitors through the space, creating clear pathways that connect key areas while honoring the site's historical context. This integration allows for seamless exploration, encouraging visitors to discover new perspectives and experiences without losing sight of the site's heritage.

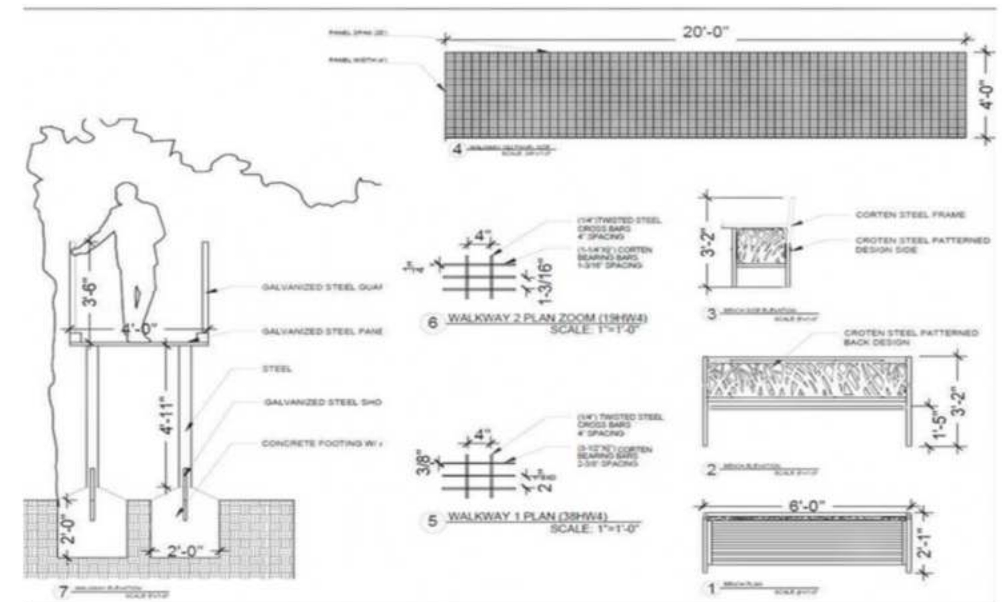
A central concept is the blending of grassy areas with the waterfront, where lush green spaces gradually transition into the bay. This fluid connection between land and water creates a serene environment, allowing visitors to enjoy scenic views while being fully immersed in the natural landscape. The design celebrates both the history of Point Richmond and its natural beauty, providing a gathering place for the community to relax and reflect. By keeping the essence of the area intact while introducing new opportunities for interaction, this project fosters a balance between preservation and revitalization.



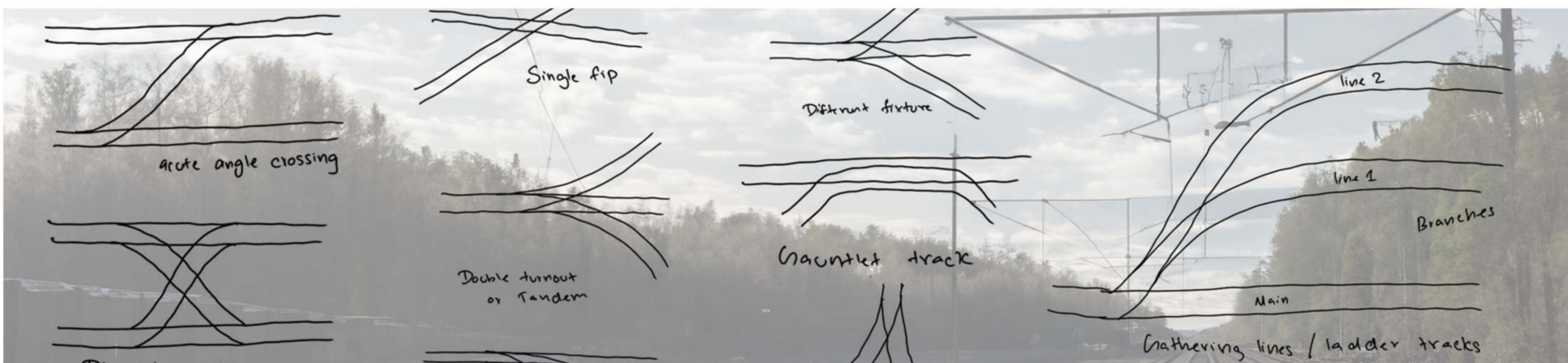
Section Drawing



Landscape Plan CAD



Detail Sections



Study of Triain Junctions

03

Harvesting Fog: Transforming Mist into Water

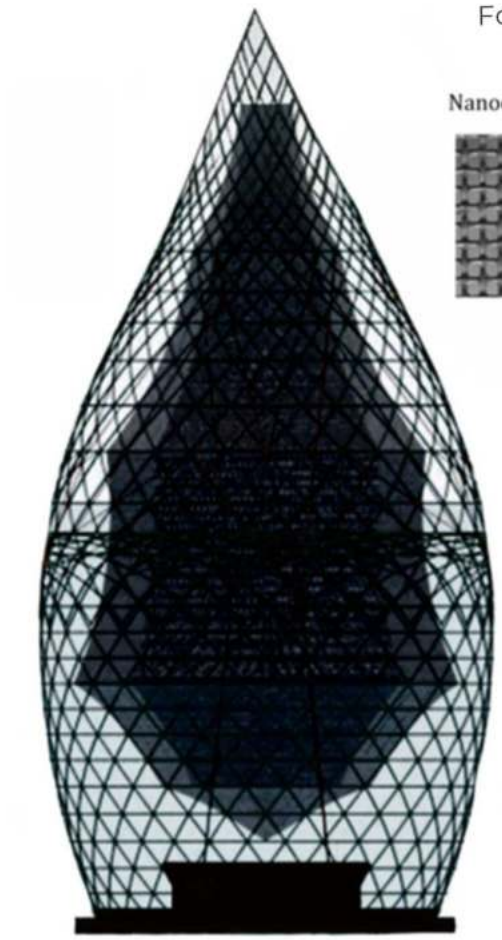
Fog Harvesting for Water Needs in the Farallon Island

BLA Student Group Project
Spring 2022
Landscape Architecture Studio

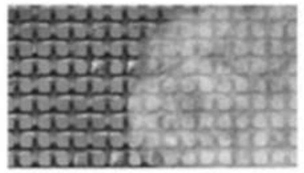
Contributions & Skills
Site Research, Concept Development, Design, Graphic Production, Product Research, Presentation, AutoCAD, Rhino, Photoshop, Illustrator

Perspective Drawing

Fog Harvest Tower

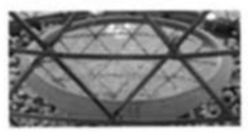


Nanoengineered Mesh



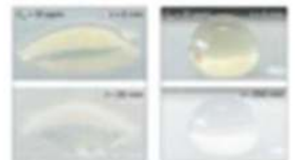
Polyester Mesh

Water Collection



Fog is absorbed into the mesh.

Once collected, it is treated to make it safe for drinking.

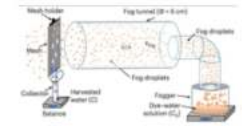


Purpose

In urban and industrial settings, fog droplets can become contaminated with dangerous levels of organic pollutants, many linked to cancer and other serious health problems, making the collected water unsafe to drink.

Material

A fine mesh coated with polymers and titanium dioxide captures fog droplets, channels them into storage, and purifies the water by breaking down organic contaminants using sunlight.



"We can make the surface reactive when it's sunny, and it stays reactive even when it's foggy or cloudy."
- Thomas Schutzius

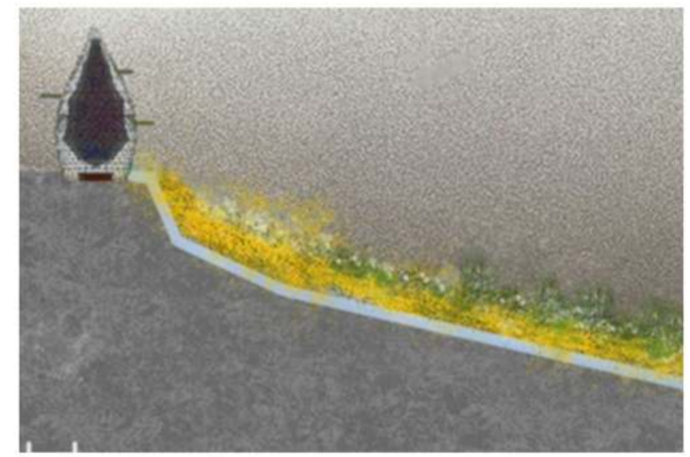
Design Concept

Located on the remote and ecologically sensitive Farallon Islands, this project reimagines fog harvesting as both functional infrastructure and landscape intervention. Inspired by the Warka Tower, the design reshapes the utilitarian form into a sculptural, droplet-like structure—echoing the very element it gathers. Positioned along the footpath to the island's historic lighthouse, the towers occupy elevated points where dense coastal fog is most abundant. Their fine mesh surfaces condense moisture from the air, directing water into underground storage cisterns that supply both native planting zones and the daily needs of the island's resident scientists, who face limited access to freshwater.

Beyond their function, the towers act as quiet sculptural markers within the stark island landscape. They draw attention to the hidden systems that sustain life in isolated environments, while their delicate presence invites reflection on water's transience and value. By merging environmental performance with poetic form, the design underscores the fragility of the island's ecosystem and offers a vision of site-responsive infrastructure that is both resilient and contemplative.

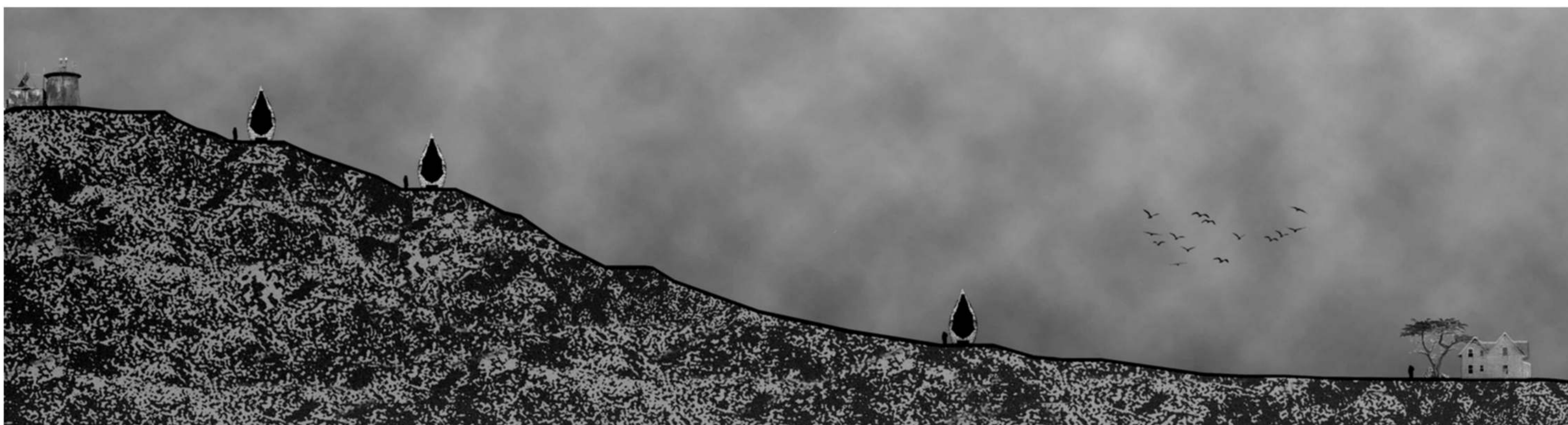
Perspective Drawing

Perspective Drawing



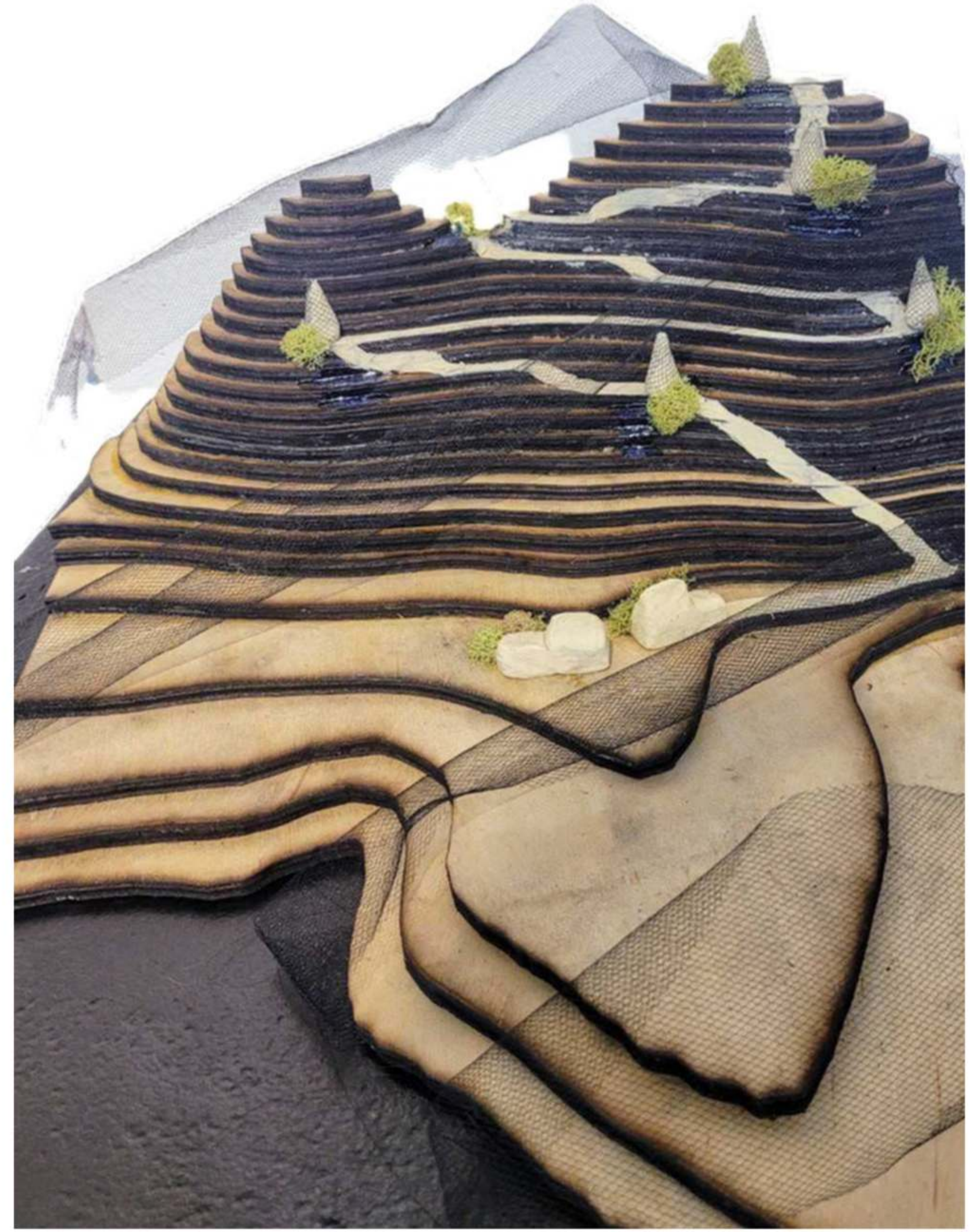
Perspective Drawing

Illustrative Perspective

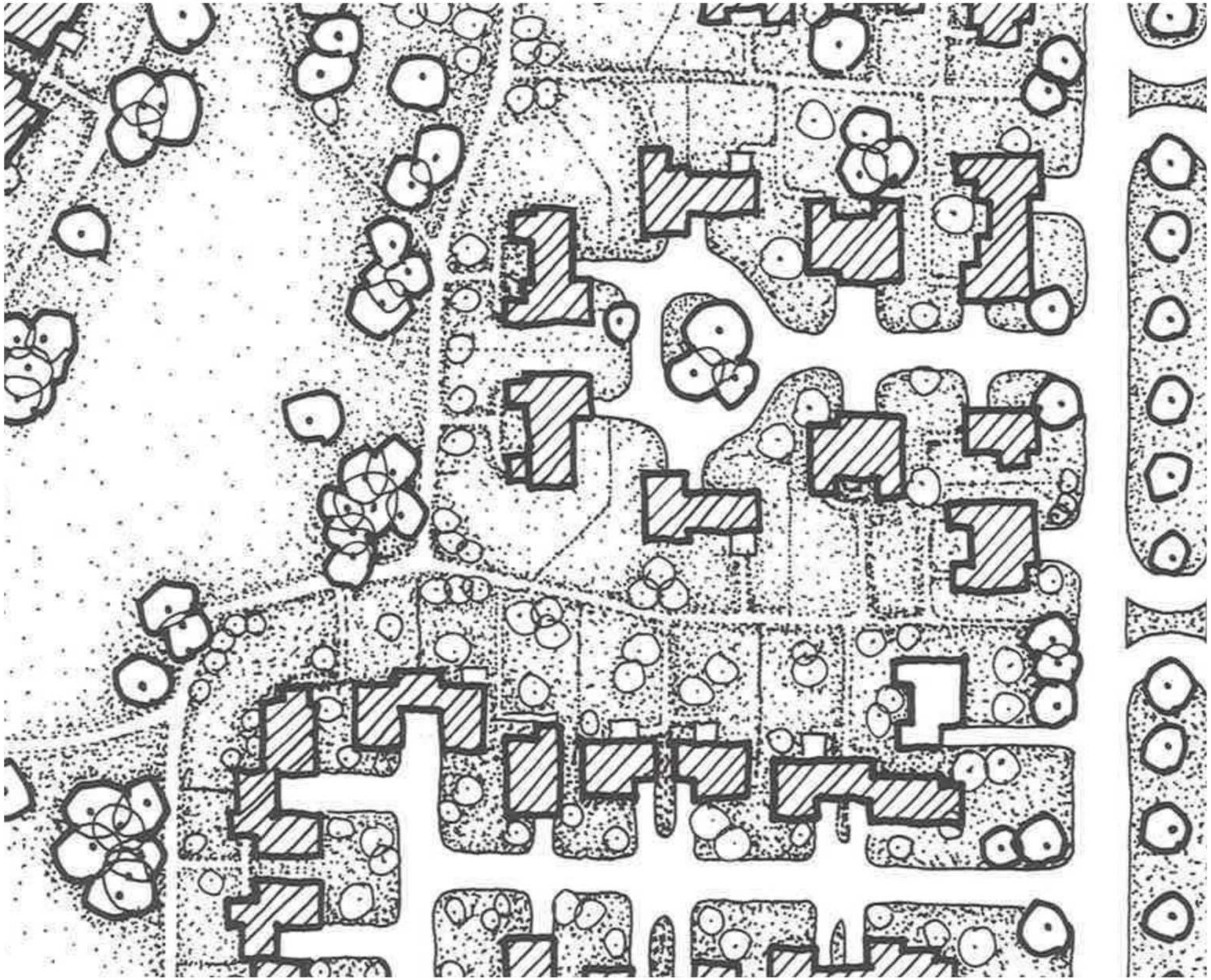


Section Drawing

Farallon Islands Topographic Model Rhino
Fog Tower Placement



Farallon Islands Topographic Physical Model
Path Placement
Fog Tower Placements



04

Reinterpretation of Radburn Garden City

Case Study Radburn Garden City
Designer: Clarence Stein & Henry Wright & Matjorie Cautley
Radburn, New Jersey
Year of Construction: 1927-1929

BLA Student Project
Fall 2023
Landscape Architecture Studio

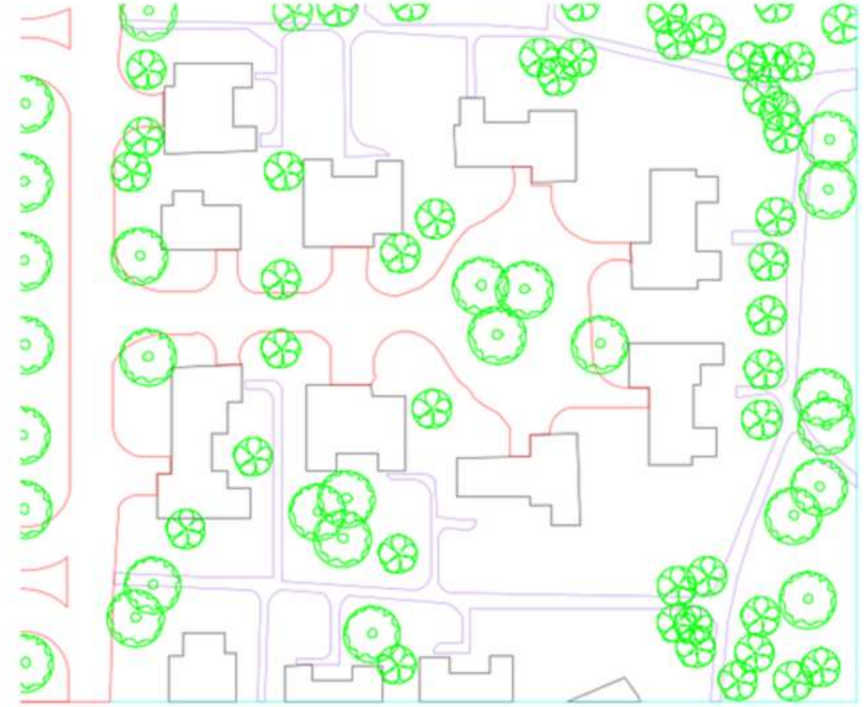
Contributions & Skills
Site Research, Concept Development, Design, Graphic Production, Product Research, Presentation, AutoCAD, Rhino, Photoshop, Illustrator

Design

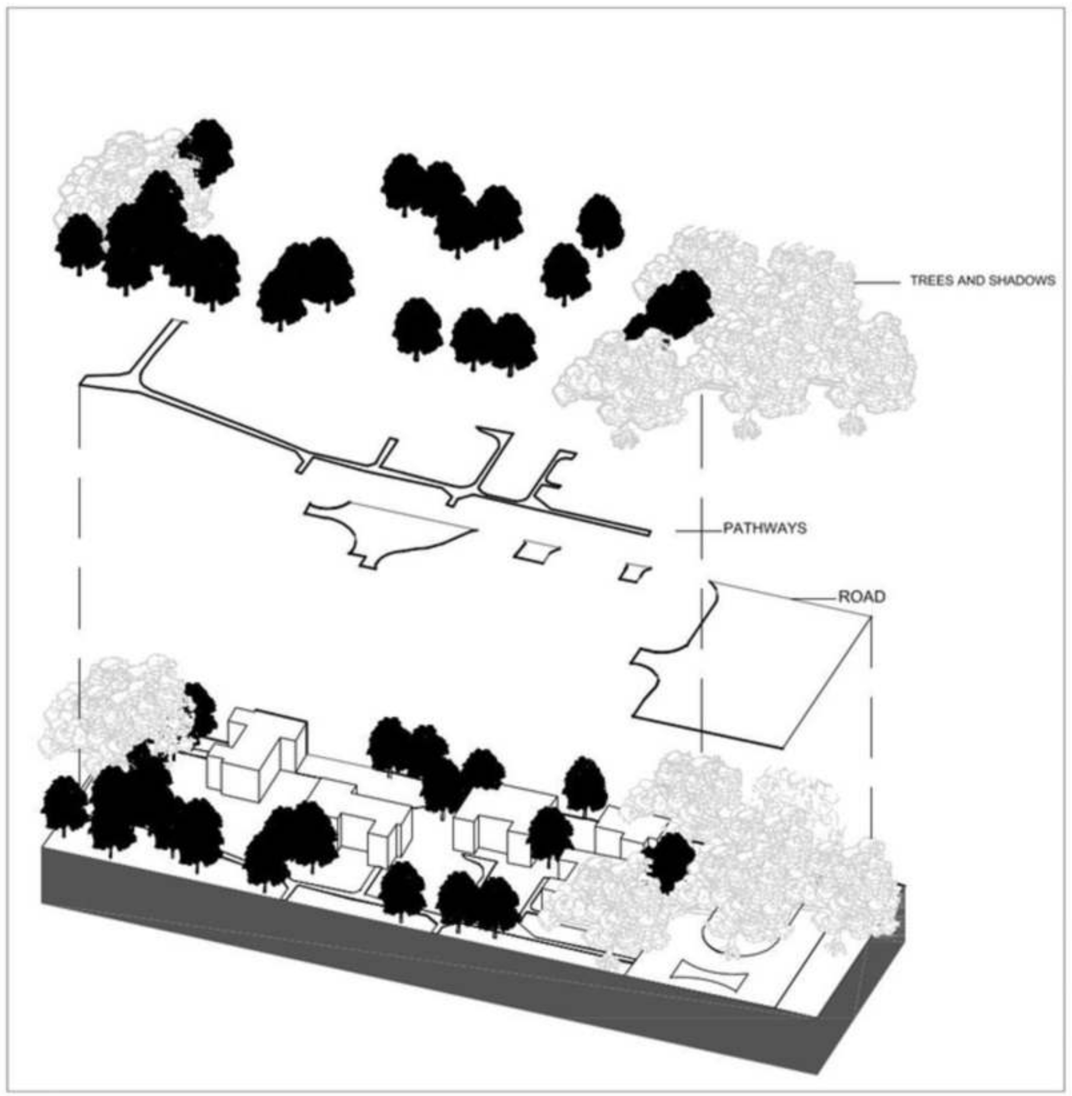
The Radburn Garden City, a 1920s urban planning innovation, prioritized community spaces and pedestrian-friendly design. It separated walking paths from roads to create safer, more peaceful neighborhoods. The “superblock” layout encouraged social interaction, but residents favored private yards over communal green spaces, and streets became unexpected play areas.

Inspired by Van Gogh’s Starry Night, this reinterpretation of Radburn emphasizes the rhythm of nature and the harmony between built and organic forms. Flowing green spaces, winding pathways, and shared zones mirror the painting’s balance of movement and tranquility, infusing the city with vibrancy and a deeper connection to nature.

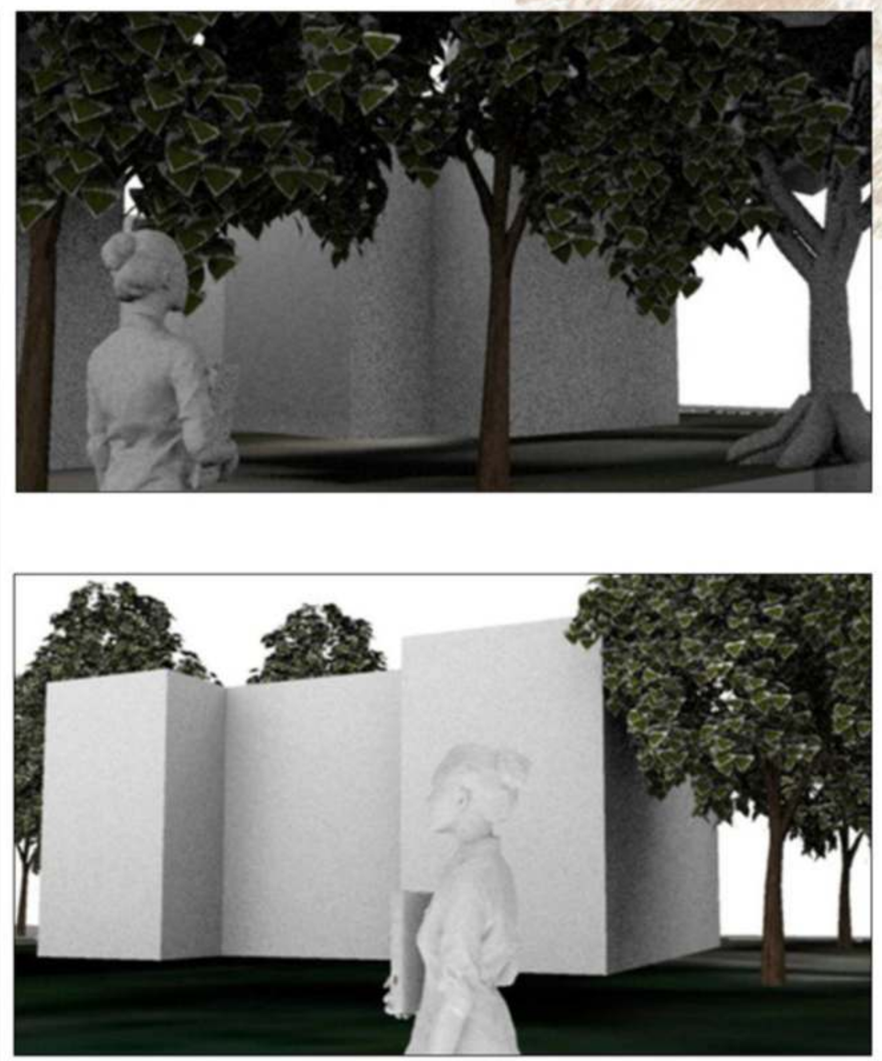
Illustrative Section of Radburn Garden City, cutting through one of the superblocks of the neighborhood.



Illustrative Plan Inspired by “Starry Night,” the Radburn Garden City’s illustrative plan embraces a vibrant color scheme with swirling blues, yellows, and whites.



4 EXPLODED AXONOMETRIC
SCALE: 1/64"=1'

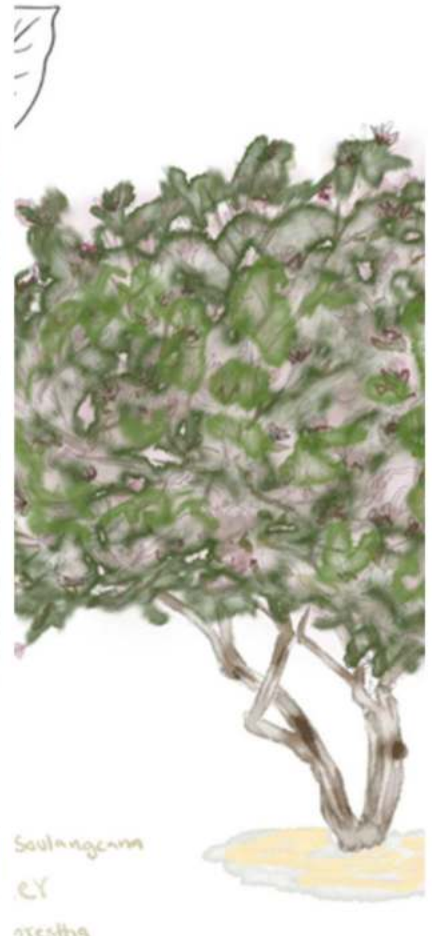


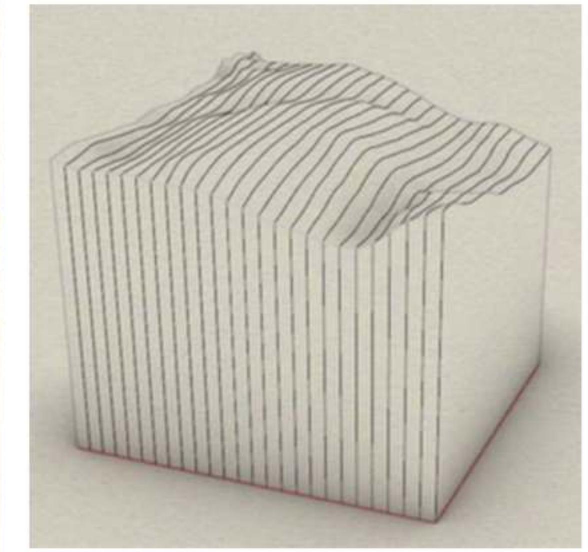
5 PERSPECTIVE VIEW
SCALE: -

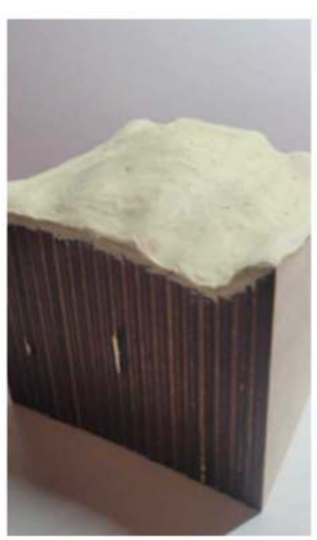
Illustrative Axonometric Section

Illustrative Perspective

Creative Explorations







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